KAVYA KA BADLA

EPISODE 1: Ulti Ginti

INT. KAVYA'S ROOM, CHAWL - NIGHT

ON SCREEN: Newspaper cutting: "Builder Mohan Saxena jailed for land fraud. Dies of heart attack in custody."

KAVYA (26) pins the cutting on a wall covered with photos. In the centre is VIKRAM RATHORE. A red circle around his face.

KAVYA
Paanch saal, Rathore sahab. Paanch saal maine wait kiya. Aaj se tumhari ulti ginti shuru.

Her mother SUDHA (50) stands at the door with a plate of rotis.

SUDHA
Kavya, yeh sab chhod de beta. Woh log bahut bade hain.

KAVYA
Isliye toh, Maa. Jitna bada aadmi, utna bada girna.

SUDHA
Tere papa yeh kabhi nahi chahte the.

KAVYA
Papa jail mein mar gaye, Maa. Unhone kya chaha, kisi ne poocha?

Sudha has no answer. She puts the plate down and leaves.

CUT TO:

INT. RATHORE GROUP OFFICE, ADITYA'S CABIN - DAY

Glass walls. City view. ADITYA RATHORE (29), sleeves rolled up, flips through Kavya's resume.

ADITYA
Kavya Mehra. MBA, gold medal. Phir bhi PA ki job? Kyun?

KAVYA
Kyunki main seekhna chahti hoon, sir. Aur Rathore Group se accha school kaunsa hai?

ADITYA
(smiling) Flattery se job nahi milti, Miss Mehra.

KAVYA
Toh mera kaam dekh lijiye. Ek hafta. Pasand na aaye toh nikaal dena.

Aditya studies her. Something about her unsettles him.

ADITYA
Monday se aa jao.

Kavya walks out. Her smile drops the moment the door closes.

INT. RATHORE GROUP OFFICE, VIKRAM'S CABIN - DAY

VIKRAM RATHORE (58) watches Kavya on a CCTV screen. His right-hand man SHEKHAR (40) stands beside him.

VIKRAM
Yeh nayi ladki kaun hai?

SHEKHAR

Aditya baba ki nayi PA. Kavya Mehra.

Vikram zooms in on her face. He goes very still.

VIKRAM
Mehra? Nahi, Shekhar. Yeh chehra maine pehle dekha hai. Pata karo yeh asli mein kaun hai.

EPISODE 2: Locker Number Saat

INT. RATHORE GROUP OFFICE - DAY

Kavya works fast. Files, meetings, calls. Aditya notices everything.

ADITYA
Tumne teen din mein woh kar diya jo meri pichli PA teen mahine mein nahi kar payi.

KAVYA
Aapne pichli PA ko kabhi thank you bola tha?

ADITYA
(laughing) Accha. Thank you, Miss Mehra.

KAVYA
Welcome, sir.

A moment between them. She breaks it first.

INT. RATHORE GROUP OFFICE, PANTRY - DAY

Kavya pours tea. Through the half-open door, she hears Shekhar on the phone.

SHEKHAR
(low) Haan, Saxena wali file locker number saat mein hai. Sahab ke study mein. Koi touch nahi karega.

Kavya's cup trembles. Saxena. Her father's name.

INT. RATHORE MANSION, PARTY HALL - NIGHT

Vikram's birthday party. Chandeliers, music, a hundred guests. Kavya arrives with Aditya, in a borrowed saree.

VIKRAM
Toh aap hain Kavya. Aditya aapki bahut tareef karta hai.

KAVYA
Aapke bete ka dil bada hai, Rathore sahab.

VIKRAM
Aur aapka? Aapka dil kitna bada hai?

KAVYA
Utna, jitni zaroorat ho.

Vikram smiles. His eyes do not.

INT. RATHORE MANSION, VIKRAM'S STUDY - NIGHT

Dark. Kavya slips in. She finds a steel locker marked 7. She works a hairpin into the lock. Click.

Inside is a red file marked "SAXENA LAND DEAL". Her father's signature, written in someone else's hand.

KAVYA
(whispering) Papa ne sign kiya hi nahi tha...

The lights snap on.

ADITYA
Kavya? Tum Papa ke study mein kya kar rahi ho?

EPISODE 3: Jhooth

INT. RATHORE MANSION, VIKRAM'S STUDY - CONTINUOUS

Kavya slides the red file behind her back.

KAVYA
Main... washroom dhoondh rahi thi. Yeh ghar toh bhool-bhulaiya hai.

ADITYA
Locker ke andar washroom?

KAVYA
Locker khula tha, sir. Maine bas band kiya.

Aditya looks at the locker. Then at her. He decides to believe her.

ADITYA
Papa ko pata chala toh hum dono ki class lag jayegi. Chalo, bahar.

EXT. RATHORE MANSION, GARDEN - NIGHT

Fairy lights. The party noise is far away. Aditya hands her a glass of juice.

ADITYA
Sach bataun? Mujhe yeh parties pasand nahi hain. Sab log Papa ko khush karne aate hain.

KAVYA

Aur aap?

ADITYA

Main bhi. Bachpan se.

KAVYA

Kabhi unke against gaye ho?

ADITYA

Ek baar. Paanch saal pehle. Unhone ek builder ko jail bhijwaya tha. Mujhe laga kuch galat hai.

Kavya stops breathing.

KAVYA

Phir?

ADITYA

Phir Papa ne kaha, business mein sawal mat poochho. Aur maine nahi poocha.

KAVYA

(softly) Kabhi kabhi sawal na poochhna bhi gunah hota hai.

Aditya looks at her for a long time.

ADITYA

Tum baaki sab se alag ho, Kavya.

She looks away. There is guilt in her eyes.

INT. KAVYA'S ROOM, CHAWL - NIGHT

Kavya hides the red file under her mattress. Sudha is asleep. Kavya lies down and stares at the ceiling fan.

KAVYA
(to herself) Bahut thak gayi hoon. Kal dekhte hain.

She switches off the light and goes to sleep.

EPISODE 4: Pehchaan

INT. RATHORE GROUP OFFICE, LOBBY - DAY

Kavya swipes her access card. Red light. Denied. Shekhar waits by the gate.

SHEKHAR
Sahab ne bulaya hai. Abhi.

INT. RATHORE GROUP OFFICE, VIKRAM'S CABIN - DAY

Vikram sits behind his desk. On it lies Kavya's old college ID. The name on it is Kavya Saxena.

VIKRAM
Baitho, Kavya Saxena.

Kavya does not sit.

KAVYA
Toh aapko pata chal gaya.

VIKRAM
Pehle din se. Tumhari aankhein bilkul tumhare baap jaisi hain. Ziddi.

KAVYA
Aapne mere papa ko fasaaya. Unke signature forge karke.

VIKRAM

Mujhe chor bol rahi ho? Mere hi office mein, mere bete ki jhoothi PA?

KAVYA
Ulta chor kotwal ko daante.

VIKRAM
Saboot hai tumhare paas?

KAVYA
Locker number saat ki red file.

Vikram laughs. He opens a drawer and drops the red file on the desk.

VIKRAM
Yeh wali? Tumhare mattress ke neeche se mili. Tumhari Maa ne Shekhar ko bahut acchi chai pilayi.

Kavya's blood runs cold.

KAVYA
Maa kahan hai?

VIKRAM
Safe hai. Abhi tak. Aaj raat sheher chhod do.

Kavya grabs the desk phone. The line is dead.

INT. RATHORE GROUP OFFICE, CORRIDOR - DAY

Kavya runs and crashes straight into Aditya.

ADITYA
Kavya? Kya hua? Tum ro kyun rahi ho?

KAVYA
Tumhare papa ne meri Maa ko utha liya hai.

ADITYA
Kya bakwaas hai yeh?

KAVYA
Mera naam Kavya Mehra nahi hai, Aditya. Main Mohan Saxena ki beti hoon.

Aditya steps back as if she has slapped him. Her phone buzzes.

ON SCREEN: Message from Maa's number: "Ek ghante mein Rathore farmhouse. Akeli aana. Police ko bataya toh Maa gayi."

EPISODE 5: Hisaab

EXT. RATHORE FARMHOUSE - NIGHT

Floodlights. Kavya walks in alone. Sudha sits tied to a chair, frightened but unhurt. Vikram and Shekhar wait.

VIKRAM
Smart ladki ho. Akeli aayi.

KAVYA
Maa ko jaane do. Mere saath jo karna hai, karo.

VIKRAM
Tum mujhe kya de sakti ho, Kavya? Tumhare paas kuch nahi bacha.

KAVYA
Bas ek sawal ka jawab. Phir main sheher chhod dungi. Papa hi kyun?

VIKRAM
Kyunki tumhara baap zameen bechne ko taiyaar nahi tha. Aur mujhe na sunne ki aadat nahi hai.

KAVYA
Isliye unke signature forge kiye. Unhe jail bhijwaya.

VIKRAM
Aur jail mein woh heart attack... woh bhi maine arrange kiya tha. Khush?

Silence. Then a voice from the dark.

ADITYA
Bahut khush, Papa.

Aditya steps into the light, his phone raised. Recording.

VIKRAM
Aditya! Yeh ladki tumhe use kar rahi hai!

ADITYA
Shayad. Lekin sach aapne khud bola. Live. Commissioner sahab sun rahe hain.

Sirens rise in the distance. Shekhar runs for the car. Police jeeps block the gate.

Vikram sinks into a chair, staring at his son.

VIKRAM
Apne hi baap ke saath yeh?

ADITYA

Aapne kisi ke baap ke saath kya kiya tha?

Police lead Vikram away. Kavya unties Sudha. They hold each other and cry.

EXT. RATHORE FARMHOUSE, GATE - NIGHT

Red and blue lights flash across Aditya's and Kavya's faces.

ADITYA
Tumne mujhse jhooth bola. Pehle din se.

KAVYA
Haan. Aur tumne phir bhi mera saath diya. Kyun?

ADITYA
Kyunki kabhi kabhi sawal na poochhna bhi gunah hota hai. Tumne hi kaha tha.

She almost smiles. Her phone rings. Unknown number. She answers.

MOHAN
Kavya... beta, main hoon. Tera papa.

The phone slips from her fingers. Sudha turns, white as a sheet.

MOHAN
Main zinda hoon. Aur Vikram akela nahi tha.